A-A-1667B
May 30, 1986
SUPERSEDING
A-A-1667A
October 15, 1982

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

BLANKET, BED (FLAME RESISTANT)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description in preference to Federal Specification DDD-B-421, type I, class 2.

This blanket is intended for use in institutions where absorbency, comfort, and permanent flame resistance are desirable characteristics. Because of its absorbency and softness, it is especially suitable for use as a bath blanket.

Salient characteristics.

The blanket shall be white in color, meeting the requirements specified in this paragraph and the requirements listed in table I. The fabric shall be a two-bar warp knit, knitted from 100 percent polyester in such a manner as to achieve a "waffle like" stitch. The fabric shall be (1) napped in order to provide a warm, comfortable, soft feel, and (2) treated with an absorbency treatment which will provide permanent absorbency characteristics which are maintained throughout the useful "life of the blanket" (see footnote 3/). The blanket shall conform to the standard sample with respect to color, softness, and "waffle like" stitch construction. A standard sample may be obtained from the contracting official issuing the invitation for bid.

TABLE I

Characteristic	Requirement	Test Method
Weight, oz./sq. yd.	2.50 (minus 5%, + unlimited)	ASTM D 3776
Bursting strength	50 psi (min.)	ASTM D 3993
Dimensional change, percent warp/filling (wales/courses)	3.5/3.5 (max.)	AATCC 96 IE - 5 complete washing drying cycles 1/
Wale/courses per. sq. inch	41 x 59 (±5%)	ASTM D 3887
Flammability		ASTM F 501 2/
char length, inches	5.5 (max.)	
after flame time, sec.	2 (max.)	
Absorbency, sec.	20 (max.)	AATCC 79 3/

FSC 7210

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1/ The washing and drying conditions for dimensional change shall be as prescribed except that 0.015% available chlorine of total volume shall be added, and a VA approved antichlor listed in the GSA - Federal Supply Schedule FSC 79 III Section A, shall be used to remove residual chlorine.

2/ Flammability shall be evaluated before and after 10 launderings by the AATCC 96 IE Method, as amended in note 1/. The test samples shall be conditioned at 70 ± 2 degrees Fahrenheit and 65% ± 2% RH for at least 24 hours. Remove only one specimen at a time from the conditioning environment. A 12 second impingement time shall be used.

3/ Permanent Absorbency Test: The blanket must demonstrate an average wetting time of twenty (20) seconds or less when tested under the criteria specified in AATCC Test Method 79. Absorbency shall be permanent for the "life of the blanket". The "life of the blanket" for testing purposes shall be deemed to be 200 "normal wash" cycles. For purposes of this test, a "normal wash" cycle will be as specified in AATCC Test Method 130, Sections 3, 4, 6 (Washing Procedure I), except that the amount of detergent shall be reduced to 20 grams since no oils or stains have been introduced. To prevent skewed results due to detergent buildup, the last three (3) normal wash cycles of each series (i.e., 8, 9, 10; 18, 19, 20;...198, 199, 200) will be run without adding any detergent. Initially and after each series of ten (10) wash cycles, the absorbency shall be checked on each of the removed samples per AATCC Test Method 79 as described above. Testing may be stopped after the samples have failed the absorbency test three consecutive times and the samples should be recorded as failing to meet requirements. The samples must meet the absorbency test on 18 or more of the 21 tests.

The issue of each ASTM and AATCC test method in effect on the date of the solicitation shall be used to determine compliance with these requirements.

The finished blanket shall be a minimum of 66 inches wide and 90 inches long. Non-selvage edges shall be hemmed with flame resistant sewing thread, which does not change the flammability characteristics of the blanket. The hem shall be sewn with stitching type EFb-1 and stitch type 401 or 501 in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 751, 1/4 inch minimum turn under, minimum 3/4 inch finished hem width, 6-10 stitches/inch, white thread. Each blanket shall be labeled, ticketed, or invoiced for fiber content in accordance with the Rules and Regulations under the Textiles Fiber Products Identification Act.

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Bath blankets being supplied to the Veterans Administration must be permanently and legibly identified with the following information. "VA PROPERTY NOT FOR SALE", when specified. The identification shall be placed parallel to the selvage edge.

Workmanship. The blanket shall be free from any defects such as holes, tears, misweaves, spots, loose or skipped stitches, rawedges, that would affect appearance and serviceability.

Inspection of the end item. The lot shall consist of blankets manufactured from the same cloth under the same production conditions. The sample unit shall be one blanket. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

A. Examination for construction and workmanship. The inspection level shall be S-3, with an acceptable quality level (AQL) of 4.0 percent defective.

B. Dimensional examination. Use level S-3, AQL 2.5 percent defective. Examine for the following defects: Length or width less than specified. Length uneven by more than 1-1/2 inches. Width uneven by more than 1 inch. Hem width less than specified. Turn under less than specified.

C. Testing. Use level S-2 with an AQL of 2.5 percent defective for all tests in table I except for the absorbency test which requires at least 5 samples to be selected from each ten thousand (10,000) blankets and tested in accordance with AATCC 79 3/. Any blanket that fails the absorbency test shall result in rejection of the lot.

Regulatory requirements. In accordance with section 23.403 of the Federal Acquisition Regulations, the Government's policy is to acquire items composed of the highest percentage of recovered materials practicable, consistent with maintaining a satisfactory level of competition without adversely affecting performance requirements or exposing suppliers' employees to undue hazards from the recovered materials.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking shall be as specified in the contract or order.

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Notes. Purchaser should specify when VA logo is required in the contract or purchase order.

THE COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION CLAUSE IS NOT REQUIRED WHEN THIS COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION IS USED FOR PROCUREMENT.

ASTM methods are available from the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.

AATCC methods are available from the American Association of Textile Chemists and Colorists, P. O. Box 12215, Research Triangle Park, NC 27709.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Military Coordinating Activities

Navy - SA
Air Force - 75
Marine Corps

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA - OSS

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

GSA - FSS

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